

Tenkawa Village more trees Sponsorship — Precedent for Mizuho

Prepared for: internal use ahead of future Mizuho meetings (上坂奈央様 / Nao Uesaka, 李ヨウ様 / Li You, Mizuho Securities Sustainable Business Division).

Purpose: Show that Japanese financial-group entities already fund small-Nara-village reforestation as CSR/SDGs sponsorship, with no formal carbon-credit product required — lowering the bar for what we're asking Mizuho to consider for Mitsue.

Source: Local archive of 広報てんかわ (Tenkawa Village monthly bulletin), issues #320–#593 (2003–2026), [research/tenkawa_koho/](#). Sponsor mentions confirmed via direct full-text search, issues #533, #539, #548, #558, #561, #570, #573, #581, #582, #585, #592, #593.

Background

Tenkawa Village (天川村, Nara) and 洞川財産区 (Dorogawa Property Ward) signed a 連携協定 (cooperation agreement) with 一般社団法人 more trees on 2021-06-07 — the Kii Peninsula's first village-level more trees agreement, represented personally by Sakamoto Ryuichi. more trees recruits and matches corporate sponsors to fund replanting of ~6 ha (ski-area plot) up to a stated ~28 ha (prefecture-returned former forestry land) with native broadleaf, chiefly Kihada (キハダ), used locally for the traditional medicine 陀羅尼助.

Confirmed sponsors

Company	Sector	First appears	Notes
デッカーズジャパン合同会社 (Deckers Japan / UGG)	Footwear brand	2021 (#533)	Annual planting visits; 3rd–6th consecutive year by 2023–2026
三井住友カード株式会社 (SMBC Card)	Credit card	2021–2022 (#539)	Repeat visitor, e.g. Nov 2023
三井住友銀行株式会社 (SMBC Bank)	Banking	by 2023 (#558)	See quote below
TRACE (美容サロン)	Beauty salon, Kansai	2022 (#561)	2nd consecutive year by 2023
株式会社ウォーターネット (Waternet)	Water-server delivery; Osaka-Kansai Expo supplier	2025 (#582)	Different mechanism — see below
三井住友ファイナンス & リース株式会社 (Sumitomo Mitsui Finance & Leasing)	Finance/leasing	2026 (#592)	Newest confirmed sponsor

Gap: #592 (2026-06-01) states **7 total sponsor companies** now support the project; the mayor's gratitude visit that issue covered only 3 (Waternet, SMBC Card, SMFL), noting "4 more not visited this time" without naming them. One sponsor beyond the 6 above remains unidentified in the archive as of 2026-07-07 (#593, newest issue at time of writing).

How the sponsorship actually works

1. **Introduction channel:** more trees recruits and matches sponsors to the village — every company's entry is described as "more trees の呼びかけにより" (at more trees' call) or, for the newest sponsor, "同法人を通じてご紹介いただいた" (introduced through more trees).
2. **What the company gives:** a donation (寄付) that funds planting/maintenance work carried out by 洞川財産区 itself — the sponsor funds, the ward executes. No public per-company yen figure is disclosed anywhere in the 274-issue archive.
3. **What the company gets:** an annual employee tree-planting site visit, framed explicitly as CSR/SDGs team-building and education, plus a values narrative tied to their own business.
4. **Cadence:** annual, multi-year relationships — not one-off gifts.
5. **One outlier mechanism:** Waternet's sponsorship runs through **Green Future Project (GFP)**, an Italian carbon-offset platform sold in Japan via 伊藤忠ファッショシステム, which funds certified forest-conservation projects and reports CO2 figures. This is the only sponsor in the archive with a formal carbon-accounting product behind it — everyone else is a plain CSR donation.

Direct quotes (from village bulletin, issue #558, 2023-08-01)

デッカーズジャパン (**Deckers Japan**), 伊藤輝希 **General Manager**: "Large-scale SDGs efforts in the US make it hard to actually gather employees. Being able to take part in forest-building in Tenkawa let us build a real connection with the village through the social contribution of planting trees, at a time when human relationships are becoming more distant."

三井住友カード株式会社 (**SMBC Card**): "Going to the mountains and experiencing it firsthand matters. Nature doesn't always go as planned — I think what you're doing is harder than what we do — please keep it up."

三井住友銀行株式会社 (**SMBC Bank**): "As a bank, we use a lot of paper in our services, so it's meaningful for a company like us, that consumes paper resources, to donate and have that used for tree-planting. This activity indirectly supports employment and contributes to regional revitalization in a genuinely meaningful way."

Why this matters for Mizuho

This is a working, multi-year example of a major Japanese financial-group family (SMBC Card, SMBC Bank, and now SMBC Finance & Leasing) sponsoring small-village reforestation as CSR/SDGs spend — introduced by the same NGO (more trees) we're already partnered with for Mitsue. It's a direct, citable comparable when raising the idea of Mizuho sponsorship with Nao/Li You-san:

- It normalizes the ask: this isn't a novel funding category we're inventing, it's the same playbook a peer financial group already runs.
- The SMBC Bank quote gives a ready-made "why a bank specifically" framing (resource-use offset narrative) that could be adapted for Mizuho's own messaging.
- Waternet's GFP route shows there's also a more formal carbon-accounting version of this if Mizuho's

sustainability team wants something closer to a certified product rather than a CSR donation.

Relation to existing package: pairs with `[[project_tenkawa_moretrees_precedent]]` (general precedent) and the in-progress `mizuho_forest_before_after.md` / `mizuho_broadleaf_species_list.md` deliverables for Nao — see `[[project_mizuho_nao_followup]]`.